

Plutarch/Government

U.S.





About the Course

Students study a life by Plutarch for two terms and then spend the rest of the year exploring topics of government through historical documents and decisions from this rotation.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 9 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

Plutarch lessons are shared with Grades 6-8, and the final term of government lessons is shared with Grades 10-11, and are also suitable for inquisitive 8th graders.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) 1 time/week 30 min	The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised) Reading PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 9 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 3 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12				Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) Current Events: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)



The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)

∞ [Video: How to Teach Plutarch \(see Citizenship: Section 7\)](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)

∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



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How To Approach



Prepare

Teachers may find it helpful to pre-read all or part of the selection from Plutarch studied and choose which news sites to offer students.

If you, the student, are learning at home, work to schedule a time with your teacher when you can complete the lessons from *Ourselves and Plutarch* together, as these lessons are much richer when shared and discussed.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources: Scan the headlines first to get an overview, and then choose a story to read.

For Citizenship books (optional): Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to get yourselves interested in the lesson. If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves and Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Share your thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions together to discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Record important ideas in your Citizenship Notebooks. Make a calendar of current events.

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Term 1		
WEEK 1	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 1	
WEEK 2	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 2	
WEEK 3	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 3	
WEEK 4	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 4	
WEEK 5	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 5	
WEEK 6	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 6	
WEEK 7	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 7	
WEEK 8	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 8	
WEEK 9	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 9	
WEEK 10	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 10	
WEEK 11	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 11	
WEEK 12	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 12	

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 13 *Week 1 / A Young Nation: American Government from 1800 to 1900*

→ INTRO

Welcome back to American Government! Last year you learned about the formation of the American Government and the reasoning behind why the Constitution and Bill of Rights were drafted and negotiated as they were. This year, we move forward to the period from 1800 to 1900 and study the way in which the new government began to take action and shape the first hundred years of our country's history.

Note: One week is built in at the end of this term for "catch up" reading, in case you miss a week or a reading takes you longer than your allotted time to complete. Please do not skip ahead if you have not completed the lesson from the week before – work through the weeks chronologically and use the catch up week (Week 11) as necessary.

→ READING

- Read Week 1 of your Reading PDF.
- With any time that you have remaining, read your summary statements and skim any written narrations from the last two years of American Government. Your summary statements should cover the time periods from Rotation 1 (800 CE - 1650 CE) and Rotation 2 (1650 CE - 1800 CE).

→ REFLECT

- Talk about the summary statements you have reviewed with your teacher or classmates. What did you remember? What had you forgotten? Did anything come to mind as you were reviewing that you had not thought about before?
- *Teacher Note: Optional Activity: Guide students in creating a bulleted list of key words that they noticed while reading their summary statements or during their discussion. Key words can be words that were repeated frequently, or that stood out to the student for any particular reason (there is no "right" set of key words). This activity is optional because it requires students to exercise a higher level analysis and might not be a useful reflective tool for all students.*

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 14 *Week 2 / Western Expansion and the Missouri Compromise (1820)*

→ INTRO

- The United States nearly doubled in size following the purchase of the Louisiana Territory from France. As new states began to petition Congress for entry to the country, the issue of slavery began to divide the nation. In 1820, Congress passed the Missouri Compromise, defining geographical boundaries that would determine whether slavery would be legal in new states. The Compromise would be followed by a series of legislative acts that together attempted to bind the new country together in the face of rapid land expansion and deep divides over slavery.

→ READING

- Read Week 2 in your Reading PDF.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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Term 2

WEEK 3 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 15

Week 3 / *Western Expansion and the Compromise of 1850*

→ INTRO

- Although the Missouri Compromise remained in effect, the acquisition of the western territory from Texas to modern-day California following the Mexican-American War reignited the question of whether new states formed from this territory would be admitted as slave states or free states. In order to maintain a tentative balance of slave to free states across the nation, Congress passed the Compromise of 1850 after efforts to ban slavery entirely from the new territory failed.

→ READING

- Read Week 3 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 16

Week 4 / *Western Expansion and the Kansas-Nebraska Act*

→ INTRO

- The Kansas-Nebraska Act of 1854 repealed the Missouri Compromise in its entirety and allowed the new territories of Kansas and Nebraska to decide the question of whether slavery would be allowed in the territories to be decided by popular sovereignty – by a vote of the people of the territories. Violence stemming from pro-slavery and abolitionists clashes in Kansas and in Washington, D.C. earned the nickname “Bleeding Kansas” and foreshadowed the start of the Civil War.

→ READING

- Read Week 4 of your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Consider the three major pieces of Congressional legislation that you have studied over the last three weeks: the Missouri Compromise, the Compromise of 1850, and the Kansas-Nebraska Act. Why do you think that Representatives and Senators in Congress increasingly decided to turn the slavery question over to popular vote? What benefits are there to a popular vote? What drawbacks or dangers might there be to a popular vote?

- Write a summary statement or short narration explaining your thoughts in response to these questions.

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 17

Week 5 / *Treaties and the Removal of Tribal Nations (Part I)*

→ INTRO

- Treaties are a tool that the Constitution allows the President to use in order to make formal agreements between the United States and another nation. Over the first four decades of the 19th century, the United States began to engage in treaty-making with American Indian Tribes, located in what are now the southern states of Tennessee, Alabama, Georgia, Florida, and Mississippi, with the goal of removing these Tribes from the south and relocating them west of the Mississippi River.

→ READING

- Read Week 5 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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Term 2

WEEK 6 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 18 *Week 6 / Treaties and the Removal of Tribal Nations (Part II)*

→ INTRO

- With the Indian Removal Act of 1830, Congress indicated their support for the removal of tribes, specifically authorizing then President Andrew Jackson to use treaties to effect land exchanges, trading land west of the Mississippi to tribes in exchange for tribal land in the south. But was the Indian Removal Act constitutional, and were the treaties themselves enforceable? We will explore the Act and its impact further in this week's reading.

→ READING

- Read Week 6 your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 19 *Week 7 / Tribal Nations before the Supreme Court*

→ INTRO

- While President Jackson and Congress worked to remove Tribes from the south by means of treaties and federal legislation, the Cherokee Nation sought to enforce their treaty rights before the Supreme Court. Over the course of two decisions within the span of the same number of years, the Supreme Court set precedent that would define the rights and status of Tribes into the modern day, and by extension, undermined the integrity of the federal government's treaty-making with these Tribes. The Indian Appropriations Act, passed in 1871 by Congress, would end treaty-making with Tribes altogether.

→ READING

- Read Week 7 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 8 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 20 *Week 8 / Congress & Southern Secession*

→ INTRO

- On December 20, 1860, South Carolina seceded from the United States. Over the next seven months, ten more states would follow suit. Four of these states drafted formal Declarations of Causes that set forth their justifications for secession. This week we will explore these Declarations in more detail and consider the impact that southern secession had on the federal Congress the states left behind.

→ READING

- Read Week 8 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Consider how the various southern secession documents compare or contrast from the Declaration of Independence. What strikes you as similar or different? Among other things, you want to think about the organization or length of the documents, the reasons given for separation, and historical events ongoing at the time that each document was signed. *Teacher note: If you have a group of students, pose this question for group discussion as an alternative to traditional narration. If you are the only student in your class, jot down some of the similarities or differences that you think of.*

- Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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Term 2

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 21

Week 9 | Congress & the Reconstruction Acts

→ INTRO

- Following the end of the Civil War and preliminary reconstruction efforts by President Johnson, Congress exerted control over the Reconstruction project by passing a series of acts now known as the Reconstruction Acts. These Acts, passed over a presidential veto by Johnson, established military control in southern states that had seceded and established strict standards for readmission to the Union.

→ READING

- Read Week 9 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 22

Week 10 | "Defective from the Start": The Constitution, Slavery, & the Civil War Amendments

→ INTRO

- In addition to taking control of Reconstruction following the close of the Civil War, Congress also proposed three amendments to the Constitution. These amendments, now known as the Civil War Amendments, banned slavery and established a series of protections and rights that are now foundational to how we think about citizenship in the United States. It would be five years before these amendments were fully ratified by the states, and it would be nearly a hundred more years until the Civil Rights Movement would take up the vision for justice and equality that these amendments had begun to advance.

→ READING

- Read Week 10 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 23

Week 11 | Reading Day

→ ASSIGNMENT

- Catch up on reading you have not completed for this term.

- Review your summary statements in chronological order so that you have a complete picture of how our readings relate to each other.

WEEK 12 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 24

ASSESSMENT

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Term 3		
WEEK 1	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 25	
WEEK 2	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 26	
WEEK 3	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 27	
WEEK 4	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 31	
WEEK 8	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 32	
WEEK 9	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12	30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 36	

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Examination

Term 1

- Tell me everything you remember about the life of Julius Caesar.
- You are a Roman citizen who lived through all of it. Caesar was on the wrong side as a young man, nearly drowned escaping, nearly starved at Pharsalus, made himself dictator for life, died in the Senate chamber, and was declared a god three days later. The city burned. The men who killed him were hunted to their deaths. Now it is quiet. Was Rome better or worse for having had him? Why?
- You are someone who admired Caesar deeply and also someone who could see clearly what he was becoming. Those two things were both true at the same time for most of the people closest to him. Think about a person in your own life, a figure in history, or a character from a story, in whom you can see greatness and destructive behavior running alongside each other. What do you do with admiration that you cannot separate from concern?
- You have followed Caesar from his early campaigns through every battle, every crisis, every triumph, and into Rome at the end. You have watched him grab sailors, swim through fire, feed horses seaweed, pardon enemies, refuse bodyguards, and finally cover his face and stop when he saw Brutus. Looking at the whole of what you witnessed: what did this man actually want, and did he ever get it?

Term 3

- Tell me everything you remember about the lives of the Gracchi.
- The brothers were nothing alike, and everything alike. Tiberius was gentle and restrained. Gaius was feisty. Think of a time when you had to choose between patience and urgency, when both paths seemed right, but for different reasons. Which did you choose? What happened? Which brother do you think you are more like, and which one do you think you should try to be?
- You have followed the Gracchi from Cornelia's house through every assembly, every law, every riot, and into the silence after. You watched Tiberius weep before his father's statue on the last morning of his life, and keep walking. You watched Gaius pull his hand quietly from his wife's grip at the door and not look back. You watched Cornelia lose both sons and go on hosting dinner parties for learned men without shedding a tear. What do you think about their behavior? Is there a right way to face grief, loss, and fear?